

Brick Title (as it will appear in the menu) : Past simple and Present perfect

☒ NEW BRICK ☐ Revamp of existing brick:

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BRICK REVIEWED BY :	Rebecca

Menu	Sub-topic	KEYWORDS (for the search engine: 3-5 words)
☐ Everyday Communication ☐ Specialist Communication ☐ Professional Communication ☒ Learning Focus	☒ Existant ☐ To be createdGrammar -- Tenses.....	Past simple Present perfect Tenses

Content	Teacher's comments for David
 Step 1: Introduction LEARNING OBJECTIVES At the end of this brick you will be able to... - Recognize the difference in meaning and focus between past simple and present perfect - Identify and use both tenses correctly in spoken and written contexts. - Pronounce “-ed” correctly CONTENT You will ... 1. Listen to a song while reading the lyrics 2. Watch 2 short videos 3. Practice key grammar using various types of exercises 4. Check your pronunciation of “-ed” 5. Test your knowledge using a timed quiz 6. You can explore the subject further using the resources provided if you wish.	

TIME: *approx. 30min would be good*

CEFR level: B1-B2

Step 2: I start

Listen to this famous song by U2, and read the lyrics below. Can you spot the verbs in the present perfect and those in the past simple?

Lyrics

I **have climbed** the highest mountains

I **have run** through the fields

Only to be with you (x2)

I **have run** I **have crawled**

I **have scaled** these city walls

These city walls

Only to be with you

But I still **haven't found** what I'm looking for (x2)

I **have kissed** honey lips

(Have) Felt the healing in the fingertips

It **burned** like fire

This burning desire

I **have spoken** with the tongue of angels

I **have held** the hand of a devil

It **was** warm in the night

I **was** cold as a stone

But I still **haven't found** what I'm looking for (x2)

I believe in the Kingdom come

Then all the colors will bleed into one

Bleed into one

But yes I'm still running

You **broke** the bonds and you

You **loosened** the chains

You **carried** the cross

Of my shame

Oh my shame

You know I believe it

But I still **haven't found** what I'm looking for (x2)

Link:

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=e3-5YC_oHjE

Il faudrait qu'ils puissent cliquer sur tous les segments en gras (soit un seul mot (« broke »), soit un segment « have climbed »).

Réponses : en jaune les verbes au present perfect, en bleu ceux au past simple.

Step 3: I learn 1: Finished and Unfinished time

Choose option below.

I learn (option 3)

Video ("watch&listen")



Watch the following video (0:00-3:15), then complete the quiz below.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=vPshbvkmWbU>

Quiz

Time can be divided into 2 categories: time which is finished, and time which is unfinished.

Select the right answer:

When we are talking about finished times, we should use ***past simple / present perfect***.

When we are talking about unfinished times, we should use ***past simple / present perfect***.

Complete the chart below:

	<i>Finished time</i>	<i>Unfinished time</i>
<i>I worked hard last week.</i>	X	
<i>I have worked hard this semester. / I've worked hard this semester</i>		X
<i>I worked hard yesterday.</i>	X	
<i>I have worked hard since January. / I've worked hard since January.</i>		X
<i>I have worked hard since 6am. / I've worked hard since 6am</i>		X
<i>I worked hard last month.</i>	X	
<i>I have worked hard this week. / I've worked hard this week</i>		X

/!\ Negative constructions

1. Present perfect

To make a present perfect sentence negative, add "not" or "n't" (contracted form) after "have":

Subject + have/has + not/n't + past participle

Affirmative sentences	Negative sentences
I have finished my homework	I have not finished my homework I haven't finished my homework
He has attended 2 English classes.	He has not attended 2 English classes. He hasn't attended 2 English classes.

2. Past simple

To make a sentence in the past simple negative: add "***did not***" or "***didn't***" (contracted form) between the subject and the verb in the infinitive:

Stop video at 3:15

@DAVID : est-ce que le quiz sera vraiment « below », ou « on the next page », ou « then click here to complete the quiz »?

Subject + *did* + not/n't + verb (infinitive)

Affirmative sentences	Negative sentences
I finished my homework yesterday.	I did not finish my homework yesterday. I didn't finish my homework
He attended his English class yesterday.	He did not attend his English class yesterday. He didn't attend his English class yesterday.

Notice the difference between:

I finished ("-ed": past simple) and *I did not finish* (infinitive)

He attended ("-ed": past simple) and *he did not attend* (infinitive)

Step 4: Summary

Time can be divided into 2 categories: time which is finished, and time which is unfinished. (Unfinished time also includes experiences that are (forever) true and still have implications for the present (experience)).

- When we are talking about finished times, we should use **past simple** (*V-ed or irregular form*)
- When we are talking about unfinished times, we should use **present perfect** (*have/has + past participle*).

Negative constructions:

- present perfect:
Subject + have/has + not/n't + past participle
- past simple:
Subject + *did* + not/n't + verb (infinitive)

FR:

Le temps peut être divisé en deux catégories : le temps achevé (= une période finie) et le temps non achevé (= une période encore en cours, ou une expérience qui reste vraie et a des implications sur le présent (l'expérience acquise)).

- Lorsque nous parlons d'un temps achevé, nous devons utiliser le **prétérit** (verbe + -ed ou forme irrégulière).
- Lorsque nous parlons d'un temps non achevé, nous devons utiliser le **present perfect** (have/has + participe passé).

Formes négatives :

- **Present perfect** :
Sujet + have/has + not/n't + participe passé

- Prétérit / Past simple : Sujet + did + not/n't + verbe (base verbale)	
Step 5: I practice 1 "Language work"	
<u>Exercise 1: Do the following sentences describe a time that is finished, or unfinished? Select the right answer.</u> 1. We flew to Tokyo in 2024. [Finished Unfinished] <i>Feedback: Finished (in 2024) > past simple</i> 2. He didn't call me last weekend. [Finished Unfinished] <i>Feedback: Finished (last weekend) > past simple</i> 3. She hasn't opened her birthday presents yet. [Unfinished Finished] <i>Feedback: Unfinished (The presents are still not opened. She will open them in the future) > present perfect</i> 4. I have studied English for three years. [Unfinished Finished] <i>Feedback: Unfinished (I am still studying English) > present perfect</i> 5. I have visited Niagara Falls many times in my life. [Unfinished Finished] <i>Feedback: Unfinished (I am still alive. My life is not finished.) > present perfect</i> 6. She graduated from high school in 2020. [Finished Unfinished] <i>Feedback: Finished (in 2020) > past simple</i> 7. She lost her phone yesterday. [Finished Unfinished] <i>Feedback: Finished (yesterday) > past simple</i> 8. I have spent a lot of time visiting London so I know how to get to the British Museum. [Unfinished Finished] <i>Feedback: It is an experience that is (forever) true and still has implications for the present (experience: Now, I know how to get to the British Museum).</i> 9. He visited his grandparents every summer when he was a child. [Finished Unfinished] <i>Feedback: Finished (when he was a child) > past simple</i>	Réponses correctes en gras. Feedback immédiat si possible.
<u>Exercise 2. Past simple or present perfect? In each sentence, select the correct answer.</u> 1. She [went has gone] to Japan last summer. <i>Feedback: last summer = finished > past simple</i> 2. We [haven't finished didn't finish] the project yet. <i>Feedback: yet = unfinished > present perfect</i> 3. He [broke has broken] his leg when he was a child. <i>Feedback: when he was a child = finished > past simple</i> 4. They [have moved moved] to their new house two months ago. <i>Feedback: two months ago = finished > past simple</i>	Réponses correctes en gras. Feedback immédiat

5. She [hasn't had|didn't have] any problems so far.
Feedback: so far = unfinished > present perfect
6. She [studied|has studied] French in 2018, when she lived in Canada.
Feedback: in 2018, when she lived in Canada = finished > past simple
7. I [met|have met] him yesterday at the conference.
Feedback: yesterday = finished > past simple
8. I [have lived|lived] in Oxford for five years now.
Feedback: for 5 years = unfinished > present perfect

Step 3: I learn 2 -Question forms

Choose option below.

I learn (option 3)
Video ("watch&listen")



Part 1: Watch the following video (0:00-3:17). The complete the chart below.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=o9sBGcRocog>

	Finished time (past simple)	Unfinished time (present perfect)
When did you get married?	X	
How long have you been married?		X
How long have you been out of work?		X
When did you lose your job?	X	
How long have you been in Toronto?		X
When did you graduate?	X	

"When" vs "How long" questions:

- We use the **past simple** tense to talk about anything that has already happened in the past, at a finished time in the past. There is no connexion between the event and the present time.
Examples:
 - When did you get married? We got married in 2014.
 - When did he start studying English? He started 3 years ago.
- On the contrary, the **present perfect** talks about something that happened in the past and is still true now (= unfinished time). The emphasis is on the length of time, and on a **state or condition** that exists between a time in the past and now. We are talking about

A afficher en feedback, une fois le tableau rempli.

what exists between a time in the past and now.

Examples:

- *How long have you been married? We have been married since 2014.*

- *How long has he learnt English? He has learnt English for 3 years.*

Compare the following examples:

Ex 1. *When did you visit Mexico?*

*I **went** to a conference there in 2005.* (past simple)

Ex 2. *Have you ever travelled to South America?*

*Yes, I **have visited** Mexico twice (in my life/so far).* (present perfect)

The “**state**” or “**condition**” of having experienced visiting Mexico continues, even if the visit is finished, so we use the present perfect.

/!\ In questions that use the past simple, the verb is in the infinitive form:

*When did you **get** (~~got~~) married? When did he **start** (~~started~~) studying English?*

Part 2: Present perfect + *for* or *since*

The present perfect is used to talk about situations that started in the past and are continuing now (= unfinished time). We sometimes use the present perfect in a question with *how long* to ask about how long a present situation has continued.

How long have Lyra and Will been married?

We talk about **how long** using the words **for** and **since**.

For is followed by a period of time / a duration (2 days, 3 weeks, 5 years...).

*They've been married **for** six months.*

Since is followed by an exact point in time (a date, an event) (Monday, last year, her birthday...)

*They've been married **since** May.*

Step 4: Summary

“When” vs. “How long”

- **The past simple** is used to talk about a finished time in the past (no link to now).

Ex: When did you get married? We got married in 2014.

- **The present perfect** is used to talk about an unfinished time, still true now. The focus is on the duration and / or the state, condition.

Ex: How long have you been married? We've been married since 2014.

Ex: Have you ever visited Italy? Yes, I have visited Rome, Pisa and Florence.

Present Perfect + *for* / *since*

Use the **present perfect** for actions that began in the past and continue now.

- **for** + period of time: *for six months, for two years*
- **since** + point in time: *since May, since 2020*

Ex:

*They've been married **for** six months.*

*They've been married **since** May.*

FR:

"When" vs. "How long"

- Le **past simple** s'utilise pour parler d'un moment **terminé dans le passé** (sans lien avec le présent).
Ex : When did you get married? We got married in 2014.
- Le **present perfect** s'utilise pour parler d'une période **non terminée**, encore vraie maintenant. L'accent est mis sur la **durée, et/ou l'état ou l'expérience**.

Ex : How long have you been married? We've been married since 2014.

Ex: Have you ever visited Italy? Yes, I have visited Rome, Pisa and Florence.

Present Perfect + *for* / *since*

On utilise le **present perfect** pour des actions qui ont commencé dans le passé et continuent dans le présent.

- **for** + une durée : *for six months, for two years*
- **since** + un moment précis : *since May, since 2020*

Ex : They've been married for six months. They've been married since May.

Step 5: I practise 2



"Language work"

Exercise 1. Past simple or present perfect? In each sentence, select the correct answer.

1. When [did you start | have you] *started* studying English?
Feedback: when = finished time > past simple
2. When [did you last travel | have you last travelled] abroad?
Feedback: when = finished time > past simple
3. How long [have you known | did you know] your best friend?
Feedback: how long = unfinished time > present perfect
4. When [did you meet | have you met] your best friend?

Réponses correctes en gras
Feedback immédiat

<i>Feedback: when = finished time > past simple</i> 5. How long [have you used did you use] your current laptop? <i>Feedback: how long = unfinished time > present perfect</i> 6. When [did you decide have you decided] to study engineering? <i>Feedback: when = finished time > past simple</i> How long [have you been interested were you interested] in technology? <i>Feedback: how long = unfinished time > present perfect</i> 7. When [did you last watch have you last watched] a really good movie? <i>Feedback: when = finished time > past simple</i> 8. How long [have you lived did you live] in your current city? <i>Feedback: how long = unfinished time > present perfect</i> 9. How long [have you been were you] at this school? <i>Feedback: how long = unfinished time > present perfect</i>	
Exercise 2. For or since? Select the right option. 1. How long have they lived here? They've lived here [since for] 2017. <i>Feedback: 2017 = date > since</i> 2. How long has she worked here? She has worked here [for since] 10 years. <i>Feedback: 10 years = duration > for</i> 3. How long have you waited for me? I have waited for you [since for] 3 o'clock. <i>Feedback: 3 o'clock = point in time > since</i> 4. How long has it been since you last saw them? I haven't seen them [for since] ages. <i>Feedback: ages (= a long period of time) = duration > for</i> 5. How long have you played the piano? I have practiced the piano [for since] 5 years. <i>Feedback: 5 years = duration > for</i>	Réponses correctes en gras. Feedback immédiat si possible.
Step 6: I say Regular past simple forms and regular past participles are formed by adding “ed” to the base verb (or just “d” if the verb ends in “e”, as in <i>close > closed</i>). However, the ending “-ed” has three possible pronunciations: /ɪd/, /t/, and /d/.	J’ai surligné en violet les besoins d’audios (mots individuels – à mettre au-dessous de chaque explication)

Read the following explanations, listen to the audio examples, and use the recording tool to record yourself.

Then listen and compare with the model.

1. We pronounce **-ed** as **/ɪd/** when the base verb ends with the sound **/t/** or **/d/**. For example:

- **want** ends with the sound **/t/** → **wanted** (/ɪd/)
- **end** ends with the sound **/d/** → **ended** (/ɪd/)

2. We pronounce **-ed** as **/t/** when the base verb ends with an **unvoiced sound** such as **/p/**, **/f/**, **/s/**, **/ʃ/**, **/tʃ/**, or **/k/**.

For example:

- **hope** ends with the sound **/p/** → **hoped**
- **laugh** ends with the sound **/f/** → **laughed**
- **fax** ends with the sound **/s/** → **faxed**
- **wash** ends with the sound **/ʃ/** → **washed**
- **watch** ends with the sound **/tʃ/** → **watched**
- **like** ends with the sound **/k/** → **liked**

3. We pronounce **-ed** as **/d/** after all other **voiced sounds**.

For example:

- **play** → **played**
- **allow** → **allowed**
- **beg** → **begged**

Remember: it's the **final sound** of the verb that decides the pronunciation, not the spelling.

For instance, **fax** ends with the **sound** **/s/** (not the letter x), and **like** ends with the **sound** **/k/** (not the letter e).

Now it's your turn. For the words below, work out if they end in **/ɪd/**, **/t/**, or **/d/**. Then listen to the audio example to check, and practise your own pronunciation using the recording tool.

Walked / waited / painted / trained / wanted / worked / cleaned / enjoyed / guessed / kissed

Step 8: I do



"Autonomy"

You've now reached the end of this brick —congratulations!

It's now time for the final test. You'll have **X minutes** to complete it, and **only one attempt** is allowed. Click **here** when you're ready to begin!

Elèves et enseignants ont besoin d'avoir accès au score final.

Réponses correctes à indiquer seulement **une fois que tous les exercices sont terminés, avec affichage du score final.**

Temps : David, tu peux faire les exercices et nous dire combien de temps ça t'a pris ? #postureélève

	Here : insérer un lien vers la page suivante (le début du test)
Exercise 1: Choose the meaning that best corresponds to each sentence. 1. I haven't finished my project yet. a) I'm still working on the project. b) I finished the project yesterday. c) I never started the project. 2. We flew to Tokyo in 2024. a) We are flying to Tokyo next week. b) We went to Tokyo in 2024. c) We go to Tokyo every summer. 3. I have been to Canada twice in my life. a) I've never visited Canada. b) I visited Canada once, in 2015. c) I've had the experience of going there two times. 4. She graduated from high school in 2020. a) She is still studying in high school. b) She has finished her high school studies. c) She retired from work in 2020. 5. He has never driven a sports car before. a) He drove a sports car last summer. b) He has no experience driving a sports car. c) He is driving a sports car right now. 6. We have known each other since childhood. a) We met each other last year. b) We still know each other today. c) We stopped being friends when we were kids.	Score /6
Exercise 2: Select the right tense (past simple or present perfect). 1. He [has bought bought] a car 4 years ago. <i>Feedback: 4 years ago > finished > past simple</i> 2. It [has rained have rained rained] since Monday. <i>Feedback: since + date (Monday) > present perfect</i> 3. [When did you go to Boston? When have you been to Boston?] <i>Feedback: Question starts with "when" > finished > past simple</i> 4. I [haven't seen hasn't seen didn't see] him for a long time. <i>Feedback: for + duration (a long time) > present perfect</i> 5. She [died has died have died] last week. <i>Feedback: last week > finished > past simple</i> 6. How long [have you known did you know] each other?	Score /10 Drop down menu Réponses correctes en gras. Feedback une fois l'exercice complété en entier.

Since 2016. <i>Feedback: Question starts with "how long" + since + date (2016) > present perfect</i> 7. He [phoned has phoned have phoned] me last Monday. <i>Feedback: last Monday > finished > past simple</i> 8. She [has watched watched] TV since 2pm. <i>Feedback: since + point in time (2pm) > present perfect</i> 9. How long [has she lived did she live] in London? Since the age of 5. <i>Feedback: Question starts with "how long" + since + point in time (the age of 5) > present perfect</i> 10. [When did his parents die? When have his parents died?] <i>Feedback: Question starts with "when" > finished > past simple</i>	
Exercise 3. Present perfect + <i>for</i> or <i>since</i>? Select the correct answer. 1. How long have you been away from home? I have been away [for since] 2 years. <i>Feedback: 2 years = duration > for</i> 2. When did you last hear from him? We haven't heard from him [since for] last Christmas. <i>Feedback: last Christmas = date > since</i> 3. When did he last open a book? He hasn't opened a book [since for] he left high-school. <i>Feedback: he left high-school = date/point in time > since</i> 4. For how long have you had a cold? I've had a cold [for since] 3 days. <i>Feedback: 3 days = duration > for</i>	Score /4 Réponses correctes en gras.
Step 9: I share "groupclass" Write 4 sentences about yourself: • 2 sentences using the present perfect • 2 sentences using the past simple In class, you will read your sentences aloud to your classmates, and try to find someone who has done or experienced something similar. Prepare 2 questions to ask your classmates: - 1 question that starts with "how long" - 1 question that starts with "when"	
Step 10: I want more Present perfect with just, already and yet	

<https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish/course/lower-intermediate/unit-14/tab/grammar>

Present perfect: 'just', 'yet', 'still' and 'already'

<https://learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/grammar/b1-b2-grammar/present-perfect-just-yet-still-already>

Present perfect with 'for' and 'since'

<https://www.bbc.co.uk/learningenglish/course/lower-intermediate/unit-12/tab/grammar>

How long

<https://learnenglish.britishcouncil.org/grammar/english-grammar-reference/how-long>

Step 11: For teachers

Cachée pour les étudiants

Speaking (and Writing)

Students ask each other “Have you ever...?” questions (written by themselves or provided by the teacher). They must answer all questions with “Yes, I have” or “No, I haven’t”. Their partner can then ask them 3 “Wh-” questions (*when, where...*) in the past simple and try to spot from their answers and body language if they are lying.

Writing

Alone or in pairs, students write 5-10 questions related to one of the following situations:

- meeting someone again after a long time, e.g. at a class reunion
- celebrities being interviewed about their careers
- job interviews

Writing (and Speaking)

Teacher gives students one or several resources (story dice, set of cards with a word / a phrase / a picture) to make a story from, using present perfect and past simple. Then students share their stories with the rest of the class.

Speaking

Teacher prepares cards with the infinitive on one side and the past on the other. Students play in pairs or small groups. They have to guess the form on the other side (and to pronounce it correctly) to be able to turn the card over and continue their turn. If they guess correctly and pronounce it well, they keep the card and take another turn. If they guess incorrectly or mispronounce the verb, they must return the card, and it's the next player's turn. The game continues until all the cards have been used. The winner is

the player with the most cards at the end.	
Step 4: Summary Time can be divided into 2 categories: time which is <u>finished</u>, and time which is <u>unfinished</u>. - When we are talking about finished times, we should use past simple (<i>V-ed or irregular form</i>) - When we are talking about unfinished times, we should use present perfect (<i>have/has + past participle</i>). Negative constructions: - present perfect: Subject + have/has + <u>not/n't</u> + past participle - past simple: Subject + did + <u>not/n't</u> + verb (infinitive) “When” vs. “How long” - The past simple is used to talk about a finished time in the past (no link to now). <i>Ex: When did you get married? We got married in 2014.</i> - The present perfect is used to talk about an unfinished time or a state, still true now. The focus is on the duration or on the experience. <i>Ex: How long have you been married? We've been married since 2014.</i> Present Perfect + for / since Use the present perfect for actions that began in the past and continue now. - for + period of time: <i>for six months, for two years</i> - since + point in time: <i>since May, since 2020</i> <i>Ex:</i> <i>They've been married for six months.</i> <i>They've been married since May.</i> FR: Le temps peut être divisé en deux catégories : le temps <u>achevé</u> (= une période finie) et le temps <u>non achevé</u> (= une période encore en cours). - Lorsque nous parlons d'un temps achevé, nous devons utiliser le prétérit (verbe + -ed ou forme irrégulière). - Lorsque nous parlons d'un temps non achevé, nous devons utiliser le present perfect (have/has + participe passé). Formes négatives :	@David : résumé complet à mettre en PDF pour téléchargement

- **Present perfect :**
Sujet + have/has + not/n't + participe passé
- **Prétérit / Past simple :**
Sujet + did + not/n't + verbe (base verbale)

"When" vs. "How long"

- Le **past simple** s'utilise pour parler d'un moment **terminé dans le passé** (sans lien avec le présent).
Ex : When did you get married? We got married in 2014.
- Le **present perfect** s'utilise pour parler d'une période **non terminée**, encore vraie maintenant, ou d'un état. L'accent est mis sur la **durée, et/ou l'état ou l'expérience**.
Ex : How long have you been married? We've been married since 2014.
Ex: Have you ever visited Italy? Yes, I have visited Rome, Pisa and Florence.

Present Perfect + for / since

On utilise le **present perfect** pour des actions qui ont commencé dans le passé et continuent dans le présent.

- **for** + une durée : *for six months, for two years*
- **since** + un moment précis : *since May, since 2020*
Ex : They've been married for six months. They've been married since May.